WF

SUBMISSION TO THE PANEL ON SECURITY · LEGISLATIVE COUNCIL OF HONG KONG

Wang Fuk Court Fire Inquiry: the record is public, the answers are hard to find

A citizen-built, machine-readable companion to the Independent Committee's published record

To	Members of the Panel on Security, Legislative Council of Hong Kong
From	Wenyun Fu, Lucia Luo and Simon Wang (Wang Fuk Court Fire Report project)
Date	19 October 2026
Status	Final — 19 October 2026 · submitted by Lucia Luo
Subject	Accessibility of the inquiry record ahead of the Committee's final report, due by end of October 2026

1 · The original site: everything published, nothing findable

The problem is not disclosure; it is **findability**.

- **What is there** — 243 documents, 6,377 pages, ~1.9m words: witness statements, hearing transcripts (six rounds), expert reports, closing submissions, departmental filings, notices, ~1,800 images.
- **In both languages** — English and Chinese, including 80 Chinese-language PDFs.
- **How it is filed** — in working order: appointment → hearings → submissions → report. The menu follows the schedule, not the seven questions.
- **Why it is hard to use** — no question-based navigation; one question's evidence spread across dozens of filings; keyword-only search; 347 scanned pages in 46 documents have no text.
- **The test** — *"was the renovation tender rigged?"* returns nothing from the official search box (Figure 2). Everything is public; almost nothing is reachable.



Figure 1 · The official archive: 243 PDFs in working order

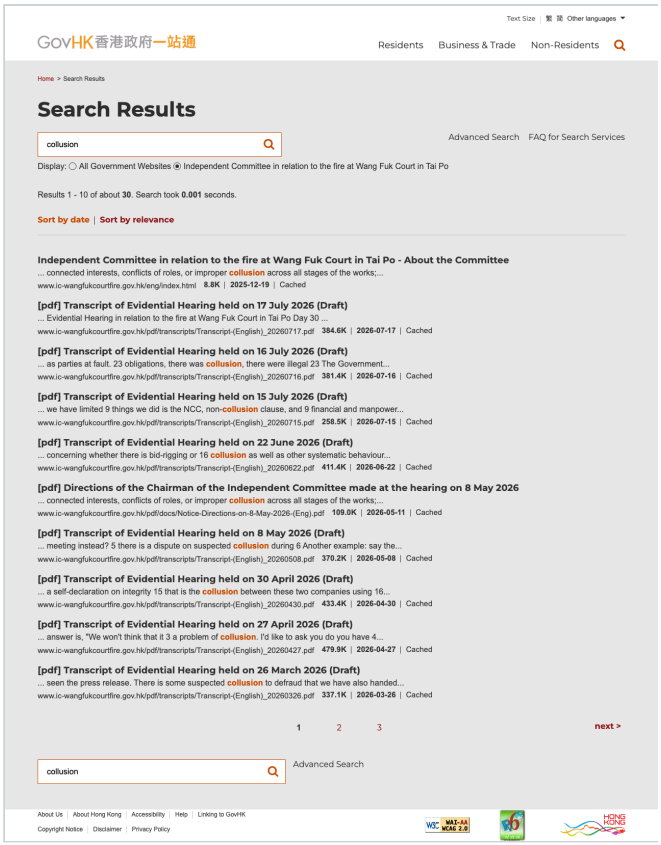


Figure 2 · Official search for “collusion”: no results

2 · What we did: PDFs to text, text to themes

243 PDFs	→	Plain text	→	7 Terms of Reference	→	Bilingual site
crawled & audited · none missed		6,377 pages · 347 OCR’d · 8,785 images		every paragraph tagged by meaning, not keyword		search · map · page citations · source PDFs

- **Converted everything** — PDF → text with page numbers; OCR for the 347 scanned pages; every image extracted.
- **Read everything** — models read all 1.9m words and tagged each document to the seven Terms of Reference by meaning, not keyword.
- **Reorganised by question** — the same documents grouped by the seven questions, with a map of how filings relate.
- **Made it citable** — every summary carries a page number and the original PDF; search spans all 243 documents, in both languages.
- **Published it** — wangfukcourtfirereport.simonsays.hk · documents · search · ToR · 中文 · SCMP letter · news

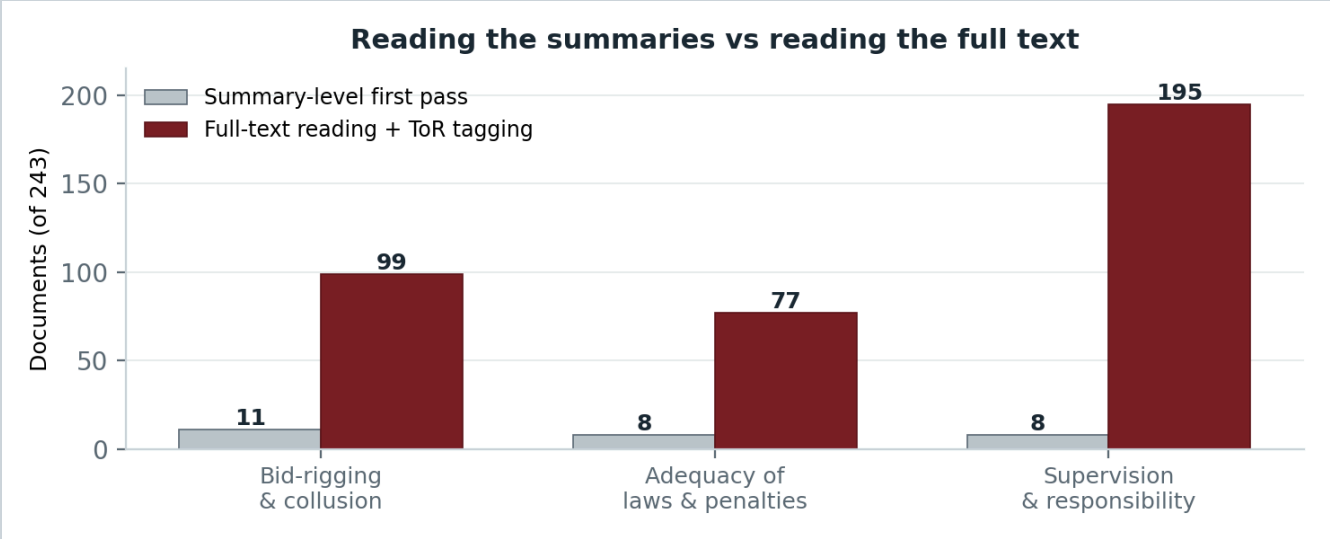


Figure 3 · Summaries vs full text, by Terms of Reference

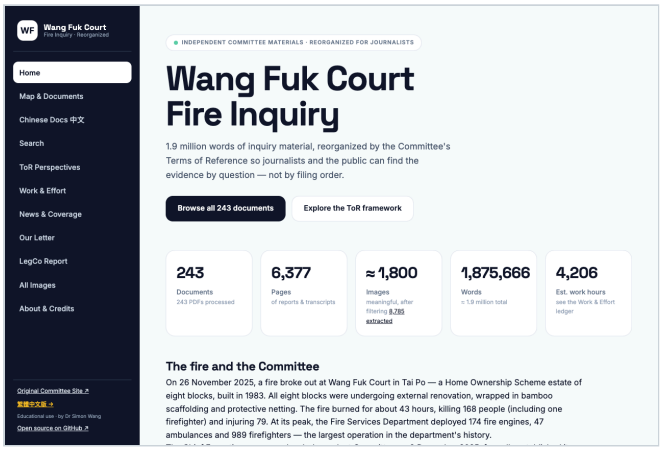


Figure 4 · Our site: organised by the seven questions

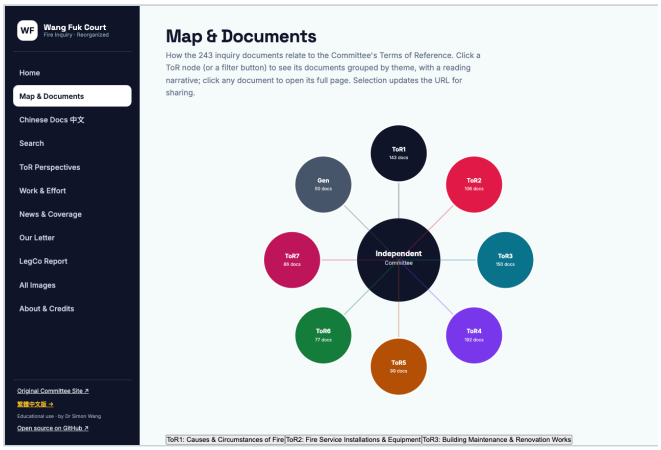


Figure 5 · Each document: summary, citations, source PDF

3 · For journalists: better informed than the original site

- **Questions, not filing order** — the seven Terms of Reference are the story structure.
- **Page-level citations** — each claim points to a page and the source PDF.
- **Both languages** — quote in English or 繁體中文 from the same index.
- **Machine-readable** — facts pull straight into a newsroom database (we indexed 595 fire-day articles).
- **Example 1 — the tender story** — "collusion" on the official site: 0 results; tagged by Terms of Reference: **99 documents**, including 85 shutdown-renewal notices filed without a site visit, an oral subcontract with no written contract, and an empty material-data folder — none of which says "bid-rigging". ToR view →
- **Example 2 — the Chinese story** — 宏福苑 coverage: 1,004 Chinese articles against 106 English in eight weeks, and no outlet able to cite the record. Our Chinese pages give a quotable paragraph and a checkable PDF page. 中文站 → · coverage →

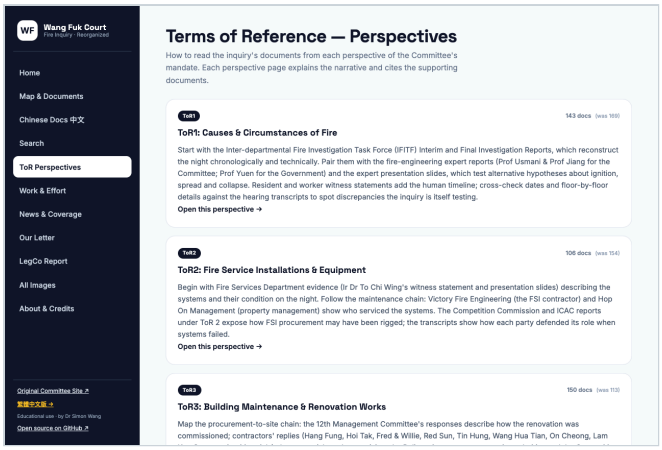


Figure 6 · ToR narratives, in both languages

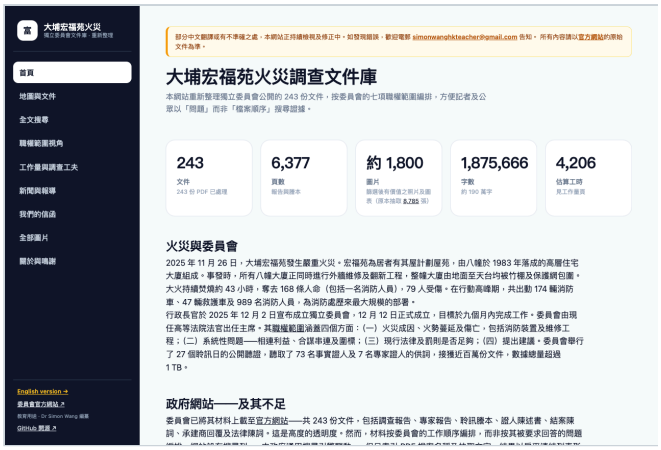


Figure 7 · The same record in 繁體中文

4 · The larger point: accessible, and AI-ready

- **Publication is not accessibility; transparency is not scrutiny.** The record owes the public the ability to answer its questions.
- **Access is cheap** — volunteers built this with routine open tools, in days.
- **AI is the next test** — as the Administration adopts AI in public administration, the documents those tools read must be AI-friendly: real text not page images, structure not flat filing, stable links and page anchors, both languages.
- **Otherwise** an AI tool repeats the search box's failure — it cannot find what no keyword contains, and the public gets a fluent summary of the press release.
- **We ask** that the findings, and the documents behind them, be published in that form: machine-readable, question-organised, bilingual.

Links

Live site (EN + 繁體中文)

All 243 documents

Full-text search

Seven Terms of Reference

中文站 Chinese site

Our letter in the SCMP

News coverage analysis

This report, as a web page

This report, as a PDF

Source code & data

The full record — summaries, search, seven ToR narratives — is live at:

https://wangfukcourtfirereport.simonsays.hk/engagement/legcoReport.html

Search: https://wangfukcourtfirereport.simonsays.hk/ · News: https://wangfukcourtfirereport.simonsays.hk/news.html

Kept current; the QR code always opens the latest version.

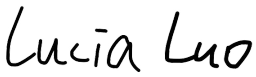
Scan to open the live report page

7 · Signatories



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Disclaimer: The views expressed in this paper are those of the authors. They do not represent the Hong Kong Baptist University and have not been endorsed by the University.